The Effectiveness of a "Praise and Token" System in Reducing Minor Disruptive Behaviors Among Grade 10 Students in Pres. Diosdado Macapagal High School

Coronejo, John Brix G.
Ferrer, Emmanuel P.
Wales, Aliah T.

Technological University of the Philippines - Taguig

A Classroom-Based Action Research
in partial fulfillment of Field Study 2

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CHAPTER 1
Introduction

Context and Rationale

Human behavior varies from one individual to another and is shaped by interactions with society. One of the primary institutions that helps shape human behavior is the school. Among the Grade 10 students at President Diosdado Macapagal High School in Taguig City, a spectrum of behaviors is observed, which has directed our attention to the conflict associated with minor disruptive classroom behaviors. According to Jati et al. (2019), disruptive behavior is defined in the literature as inappropriate behavior exhibited by students during the learning process. These behaviors may manifest as frequently standing up and roaming around the classroom, engaging in side conversations, and changing seats without permission. Consequently, these behaviors may disrupt the flow of classroom instruction by causing delays, diverting students' attention, and interrupting their engagement with the lesson. Supported by Hasibuan and Astuti (2026), although each behavior may appear minor in isolation, its cumulative effect is substantial. Such repeated low-level behaviors interrupt lesson flow, reduce instructional time, weaken teacher-student communication, and compromise the concentration of other learners. These minor negative behaviors raise concerns among fellow peers, as these simple actions can serve as distractions that divert students' already limited attention. According to Untalan (2026), in the 2025 PISA results, Filipino learners reported frequent disruptions due to noise and lack of attention, with 75% reporting that students do not listen to what the teacher says and 65% reporting that students cannot work well in at least some lessons.

At the same time, these behaviors may not occur in isolation. Students may experience socioeconomic and personal challenges, such as financial instability, limited access to emotional and mental health support, family conflict, and other

circumstances that may influence their behavior consciously or unconsciously. Ashraf et al. (2024), home illiteracy and socioeconomic problems prevent parents from playing their required role in children's behavioral development. These factors may contribute to challenges in maintaining students' attention and engagement during lessons. These challenges hinder smooth transitions between teaching and learning among students and teachers. Therefore, appropriate interventions and effective classroom management strategies play a significant role in protecting students' engagement.

Classroom management helps establish the overall climate of the classroom, where routines, rules, and student engagement are established and reinforced. These practices help students become familiar with classroom expectations and understand which actions contribute to a positive learning environment. Positive reinforcement can be implemented through interventions such as behavior-specific praise given alongside tokens, aimed at fostering a supportive classroom environment that encourages students to reduce undesirable behaviors and exemplify desired behaviors. In the study, Ismail (2023) found that 75% of the responses agreed on and valued the importance of positive reinforcement for students' motivation and performance. This is exemplified by the study of Taratingan, Morales, and Gomez-Rock (2024), in which, by the end of their use of a token-driven strategy, students gradually became more motivated and confident due to the recognition and satisfaction they received after receiving STAR stickers and feedback.

Ultimately, this study aligns with Sustainable Development Goal 4: Quality Education. It aims to contribute to a more positive learning experience for both students and teachers. To bridge the disconnection caused by disruptive behavior, we aim to utilize interventions such as praise and tokens to strengthen classroom management, protect instructional time, sustain attention, and shape positive behavior while fostering

a supportive classroom environment that strengthens students' unique perspectives, understanding of knowledge, and talents.

Purpose of the Study

This study aims to determine the effectiveness of a token economy strengthened by behavior-specific praise in reducing minor disruptive behaviors and fostering positive classroom behavior among Grade 10 students at President Diosdado Macapagal High School. The intervention addresses observed low-level disruptions, such as talking out of turn and unnecessary noise, and their effects on the learning environment and the flow of lessons. The study further examines students' responses to the intervention and whether consistent praise and token reinforcement can encourage positive conduct rather than produce only short-term compliance.

The following are the main beneficiaries of the research:

The School

The study aims to provide information that will support a better understanding of students' behavior and the impact of a reward system on classroom behavior. The findings may help the school identify strategies for improving classroom management and creating a more positive learning environment.

The Teachers

The study aims to help teachers observe the effectiveness of the Praise-and-Token System in managing classroom behavior. It may also help teachers strengthen

classroom relationships and encourage positive student behavior through constructive feedback, behavior-specific praise, and token reinforcement.

The Grade 10 Students

The study aims to help students replace minor disruptive behaviors with positive classroom behaviors through constructive feedback, behavior-specific praise, and token reinforcement. Consequently, the intervention may help promote a more organized and supportive learning environment that encourages students to participate positively in classroom activities.

Future Researchers

The study aims to provide information about student behavior and the use of praise and token reinforcement as a classroom management strategy. It may also identify gaps and areas for further investigation that future researchers can explore in related studies.

Action Research Questions

This study generally aims to determine the effectiveness of the "Praise and Token" system in reducing minor disruptive behaviors among Grade 10 Food Service students at President Diosdado Macapagal High School - Taguig City.

Specifically, it seeks to answer the following questions:

1. What is the frequency of minor disruptive behaviors (e.g., unnecessary side-talking, inattentiveness, and out-of-seat behavior) observed among the students

during class discussions and activities prior to the implementation of the "Praise and Token" system?

2. What is the frequency of minor disruptive behaviors observed among the students after the implementation of the "Praise and Token" system?
3. Is there a significant difference in the frequency of minor disruptive behaviors before and after the integration of the intervention?
4. How do the students respond to the use of custom peso bills (10, 20, 50, 100) as a reinforcement tool for active participation, correct recitation, and discipline?

Innovation, Intervention, or Strategy

To address the recurring minor disruptive behaviors—such as side-talking, inattentiveness, and out-of-seat behavior—during Grade 10 TLE - Food Service class discussions, the researchers developed an interactive behavior modification strategy titled the **"Praise and Token" System.**

This intervention combines B.F. Skinner's principles of positive reinforcement with a structured Classroom Currency Economy. The strategy requires students to adhere to five core classroom rules (active listening, raising hands, respectful interaction, proper seating, and compliance with basic regulations) as a prerequisite to participate in the economy. By coupling Behavior-Specific Praise (BSP) with tangible custom peso bills, the intervention incentivizes academic participation while systematically discouraging minor disruptions.

1. Structure of the Custom Currency System

The intervention utilizes custom-designed classroom peso bills. To ensure a unique connection to the learners, the bills feature original, non-AI-generated animal portraits and motivational quotes rather than traditional national heroes, symbolizing the specific academic effort demonstrated by the learner.

Students earn base currencies graded by the cognitive difficulty of their recitation and their behavioral discipline:

- **₱20 Bill:** Awarded for basic recall questions (What/Who) or brave attempts that provide close, relevant answers.
- **₱50 Bill:** Awarded for providing strong reasoning (Why), enumerating concepts, or explaining topics clearly.
- **₱100 Bill:** Awarded for accurately answering complex processes (How), breaking down multi-step procedures, or offering highly insightful comparisons.

To prevent grade inflation, the system utilizes a **₱10 Bill Cap Mechanic**. Daily rewards for high-value bills are capped at ₱100 per student. Once a student accumulates ₱100 in a single session, any subsequent valid participation is rewarded with a ₱10 bill, recognizing continued effort while maintaining economic balance.

2. Earning Mechanics and Protocol

The token system is applied dynamically during lectures and activities without disrupting instructional flow. The teacher-researcher employs targeted intermittent reinforcement. For academic answers, the teacher immediately pairs verbal praise

with the corresponding bill. For behavioral compliance, the teacher utilizes "silent delivery" (quietly placing a bill on an on-task student's desk during seatwork) or ties behavioral praise to recitation opportunities (e.g., calling on a student specifically because they raised their hand silently).

3. Redemption and the Mystery Pouch

Students must save their lower denomination bills to exchange for higher-tier rewards at the end of class sessions. The accumulated currency translates directly into academic incentives:

- **₱500 Bill:** Earned by accumulating smaller bills, this grants a +5 point reward applicable to any quiz, homework, or activity.
- **₱1000 Bill:** Grants a +10 point reward applicable to any quiz, homework, activity, or major exam.

Alternatively, students may engage in the **Mystery Pouch Challenge**. For ₱100, a student can blindly draw a random bill from a pouch. This introduces an element of chance, where they might instantly win a ₱500 or ₱1,000 bill, or risk drawing a lower ₱20 or ₱50 bill.

4. Extent and Limitations

The implementation is strictly governed by terms and conditions: lost or destroyed bills will not be replaced, and any attempt at counterfeiting results in immediate disqualification from the reward system. The token economy is limited exclusively to the Grade 10 Food Service periods under the supervision of the teacher-researcher.

Pre-Implementation Phase

The preliminary phase of this research involves analyzing the priority behavioral needs of the Grade 10 Food Service classes. Upon identifying minor disruptions as a primary barrier to instruction, the researchers designed the "Praise and Token" system and crafted the custom animal-themed peso bills (₱10, ₱20, ₱50, ₱100).

A standardized Behavioral Observation Tally Sheet was formulated, featuring strict operational definitions and thresholds to ensure valid data collection. To differentiate natural student movement from actual disruption, a "5-second threshold rule" was established (e.g., side-talking or out-of-seat behaviors are only recorded if they persist for more than 5 seconds or explicitly interrupt the instructor).

Finally, the proposal and action plan will be presented to the management. Endorsements will be secured from the Cooperating Teacher, Ma'am Flair Macalanda, and a formal request for approval will be submitted to the Principal of Pres. Diosdado Macapagal High School. The intervention materials and observation tools will be finalized based on any recommendations from the school administration.

Implementation Phase

Employ the strategy to the target participants. (The proponent/s orient the research participants as to the study's nature, scope, and timeline; seek the participants' free, prior, and informed consent and address other ethical concerns; implement the strategy or employ the intervention or innovation; document the process of implementation, make appropriate changes and adjustments, and assess the progress using the strategy or intervention).

Table 1: Implementation Timeline

Phase	Activity	Duration
Pre-Implementation	Securing Approvals, Material Preparation, and Orientation with CTs.	Week 1 & 2 (Nov 23 - Dec 4)
Pre-Data Gathering (O1)	Baseline behavioral observation without intervention	Week 3 (Dec 7 - 11)
1st Local Teaching Demonstration	Data gathering paused to accommodate the demonstration	Weeks 4 (Dec 14 - 18)
Implementation (X)	Execution of the Praise and Token System	Week 5 & 6 (Jan 4 - 15)
Post-Data Gathering (O2)	Post-intervention behavioral observation	Week 7 (Jan 18 - 22)
Post-Implementation	Data analysis, manuscript writing, and CBAR final presentation	Week 8 Onward (Jan 25 +)

Post Implementation Phase

The implementation phase follows a structured timeline. First, the researchers will orient the Grade 10 research participants on the mechanics of the Classroom Currency Economy, outlining the earning protocols, the classroom rules, and the redemption incentives (+5 and +10 grade points).

During the actual class sessions, task delegation among the researchers will be strictly observed to ensure the validity of data. The lead student-teacher will manage instruction, facilitate the lecture, and execute the intervention by distributing the peso

bills alongside Behavior-Specific Praise (BSP). Concurrently, a co-researcher (or the cooperating teacher) will be stationed at the back of the room acting strictly as the non-participant observer. Using the standardized tally sheet, the observer will document the frequency of minor disruptive behaviors, applying the pre-determined duration thresholds to ensure accurate recording. Progress will be continuously assessed, and minor adjustments to the pacing of token distribution will be made if necessary.

CHAPTER 2
Action Research Methods

This chapter presents and discusses the research design, participants and sources of data, data gathering procedures, data analysis plan, and ethical considerations employed in evaluating the effectiveness of the "Praise and Token" system. These methodological components are detailed to provide a transparent, systematic, and replicable framework for addressing minor disruptive classroom behaviors through proactive positive reinforcement.

Conceptual Framework

The conceptual paradigm of this study adopts the Input-Process-Output (IPO) model to delineate how the "Praise and Token" system systematically reduces minor disruptive behaviors during discussion-heavy sessions in Grade 10 TLE – Food Service.

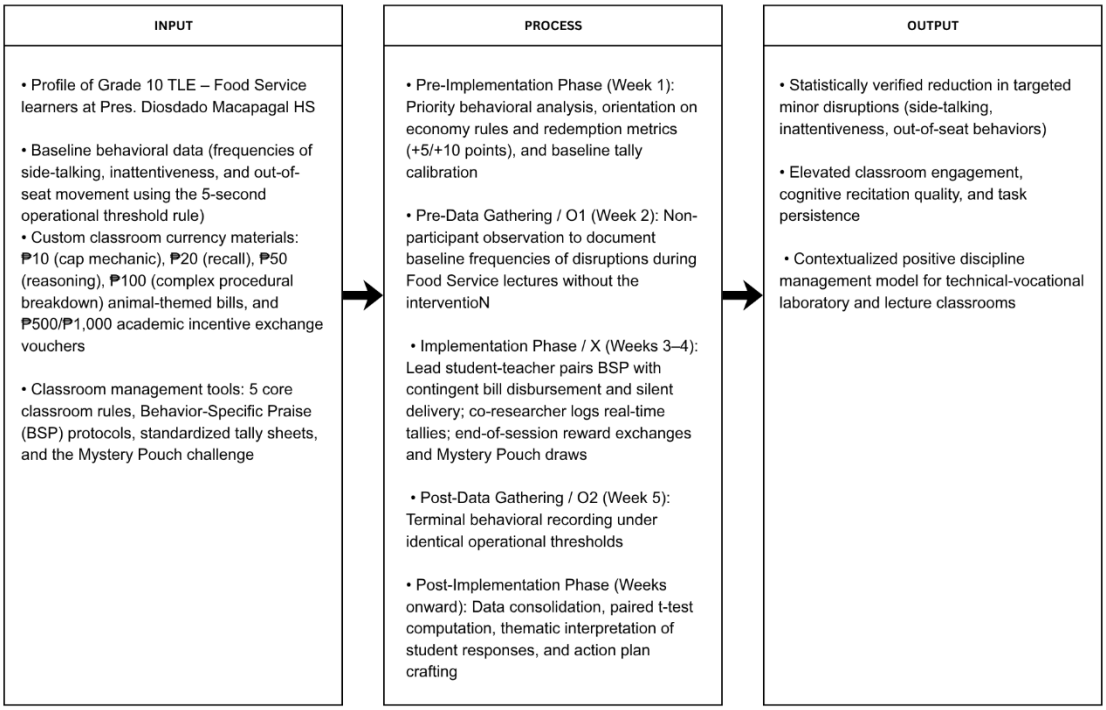


Figure 1.0 Input-Process-Output

The **Input** consists of the intact Grade 10 TLE – Food Service class at Pres. Diosdado Macapagal High School, baseline frequency records of minor disruptions (specifically side-talking, inattentiveness, and out-of-seat movement governed by a 5-second observation rule), and the components of the Classroom Currency Economy. These materials include five core classroom rules, Behavior-Specific Praise (BSP) rubrics, custom animal-themed peso bills tiered by cognitive effort (₱20 for recall, ₱50 for reasoning, and ₱100 for procedural analysis, capped daily at ₱100 with a ₱10 overflow mechanic), and reward redemption assets like ₱500 and ₱1,000 academic vouchers (+5 and +10 grade points) and the Mystery Pouch challenge.

The **Process** executes the action research cycle across five sequential phases over five weeks. It begins with pre-implementation activities in Week 1 to secure ethical approvals and orient learners on economy mechanics, followed by Week 2 baseline observations (O_1) conducted by an independent classroom observer. During the intervention phase in Weeks 3 and 4 (X), the student-teacher delivers instruction while pairing verbal praise with immediate bill disbursements and silent desk delivery, alongside real-time behavioral logging and end-of-class reward redemptions. In Week 5, terminal observations (O_2) are recorded using identical thresholds. The cycle concludes with post-implementation analysis using descriptive frequency measures and paired samples t-tests to evaluate behavioral changes.

The **Output** represents the direct results and scholarly products of the study, highlighted by a statistically significant reduction in classroom disruptions, heightened learner engagement and higher-order recitation, reclaimed instructional pacing, and a validated Positive Discipline Action Plan suitable for Technical-Vocational classrooms.

The framework directly addresses the classroom problem through the principle of differential reinforcement of incompatible behaviors. Minor disruptions generally occur

when students face passive pacing or lack immediate incentives for active attention. Because behaviors like formulating a reasoned recitation to earn high-tier currency or focusing quietly on seatwork to receive silent token deliveries are physically and cognitively incompatible with side-talking or roaming, the intervention systematically replaces disruptive habits with productive conduct. Meanwhile, pairing immediate Behavior-Specific Praise with tangible bills bridges the gap to long-term grade incentives, motivating learners to maintain self-regulation and establishing an orderly, positive classroom environment.

Research Design

This study utilizes a **One-Group Pre-test–Post-test Action Research Design**, integrated with descriptive-evaluative and comparative methods, to determine the effectiveness of the "Praise and Token" system in curbing minor disruptive behaviors among Grade 10 TLE – Food Service students. In accordance with the classroom-based action research paradigm, this design focuses on diagnosing, intervening in, and resolving authentic instructional dilemmas directly within an intact classroom environment rather than in an artificial, split-group experimental setting.

The design is operationally structured around three sequential stages:

1. ***O_1* (Pre-Intervention Observation / Pre-test):** Denotes the baseline quantitative frequency tallies of targeted minor disruptive behaviors—specifically unnecessary side-talking, off-task inattentiveness, and out-of-seat movement—recorded by a dedicated observer across regular Food Service lecture periods prior to the introduction of the currency system. To safeguard measurement

reliability, each recorded instance must satisfy the established 5-second operational threshold rule.

2. **X (Classroom Action Intervention):** Represents the implementation of the "Praise and Token" Classroom Currency Economy across instructional sessions. This encompasses the contingent administration of Behavior-Specific Praise (BSP), instant delivery of tiered animal-themed peso bills (₱10, ₱20, ₱50, ₱100), silent delivery reinforcement during seatwork, and structured token redemption cycles for academic incentives (+5 and +10 grade points) and the Mystery Pouch challenge.

3. **O_2 (Post-Intervention Observation / Post-test):** Represents the terminal measurement of disruptive behaviors recorded during subsequent Food Service sessions following the intervention period, administered under identical observational protocols, duration thresholds, and tally metrics as O_1.

Descriptive and comparative analyses are employed to evaluate changes between baseline (O_1) and post-intervention (O_2) metrics, providing empirical evidence to validate whether the strategy effectively curbs disruptions and warrants continuous integration into long-term classroom management routines.

Participants/ Sampling and/or Other Sources of Data/ Information

The primary participants of this study comprise an intact section of Grade 10 learners enrolled in the Technology and Livelihood Education (TLE) – Food Service specialization at Pres. Diosdado Macapagal High School during the practice teaching deployment period.

1. Sampling Method and Selection Criteria

The researchers utilize **Purposive Sampling** (specifically intact group sampling) to identify the target class section. The inclusion criteria are defined as follows:

- **Enrolment and Specialization:** Officially enrolled in Grade 10 TLE - Food Service under the class load of cooperating teacher, Ma'am Flair Macalanda.
- **Observed Behavioral Need:** Demonstrating recurring baseline instances of minor disruptive behaviors (e.g., unnecessary side-talking, inattentiveness, and out-of-seat behavior) during lecture discussions and written seatwork.
- **Research Integrity and Non-Contamination:** Selected specifically because this class section has **not** been previously exposed to any trial iterations of the "Praise and Token" system or classroom currency economy. This ensures an uncontaminated baseline observation (O1) and protects the internal validity of the action research against treatment diffusion or prior behavioral conditioning.

2. Participant Characteristics

The chosen section consists of an intact class of Grade 10 male and female adolescent learners. As senior junior high school students in a technical-vocational strand, maintaining focus during discussion-heavy sessions is vital for mastering core Food Service concepts and succeeding in written tasks and examinations.

3. Other Sources of Data and Information

To triangulate the behavioral observations and provide a complete picture of the intervention's impact, the study utilizes the following supplementary data sources:

- **Standardized Behavioral Observation Tally Sheets:** Quantitative recording sheets maintained by the designated co-researcher or observer stationed at the rear of the room, utilizing the 5-second operational threshold rule to log behavioral frequencies.
- **Currency Redemption and Ledger Logs:** Physical tracking records documenting the distribution of base bills (₱10, ₱20, ₱50, ₱100) and the exchange transactions for higher-tier reward bills (₱500, ₱1,000) or Mystery Pouch draws.
- **Daily Lesson Logs (DLL):** Approved instructional materials used to correlate behavioral trends with specific teaching strategies, topic complexities, and lesson phases across the 4-week research cycle.

Data Gathering Procedure

The researcher will utilize classroom observations, and observation tally sheets to gather data in identifying the effectiveness of Praise-and-Tokens in mitigating minor disruptive behavior. These methods will be used to record the frequency of the identified minor disruptive behaviors before and during the implementation of the intervention, as well as after its completion. The observation checklist and tally sheets will serve as the primary research instruments for documenting the occurrence of behaviors such as frequently standing up or roaming around the classroom, side conversations, and changing seats. Classroom observation is appropriate for this study because it allows the proponents to monitor the actual occurrence of the target behaviors in the classroom setting. The gathered data will be organized and examined to identify changes in the frequency of these behaviors and determine the observed outcomes following the implementation of the Praise-and-Token System. The data-gathering procedures are divided into three phases: pre-data gathering, actual data gathering, and post-data

gathering.

Pre-Data Gathering

Before gathering the data, the researchers will prepare the necessary research documents and intervention materials (e.g., observation tally sheets) for the implementation of the Praise-and-Token System. They will review and refine the action research proposal, develop the intervention guidelines, and prepare the observation checklist and tally sheets that will be used to record the frequency of the identified minor disruptive behaviors among Grade 10 students.

A Letter of Request to Conduct Research will be submitted to the school head or authorized administrator to obtain permission to conduct the study. The researchers will also consult their research adviser and critique teacher regarding the research methods, intervention procedures, and data-gathering instruments. Their recommendations and constructive feedback will be considered in refining the procedures to ensure that the intervention and data-gathering methods are appropriate for the objectives of the study.

Before implementing the intervention, the researchers will conduct baseline classroom observations to determine the initial frequency of the identified minor disruptive behaviors. The same observation checklist and tally sheets will be used throughout the study to maintain consistency in recording the data. The researchers will also explain the rules and mechanics of the Praise-and-Token System to the participants before the intervention begins.

Actual Data Gathering

During the implementation phase, actual data gathering will take place alongside the execution of the Praise-and-Token System. To accommodate the 1st Local Teaching Demonstration, the active intervention will be strategically implemented during Weeks 5 and 6 (January 4 to 15, 2027). During these sessions, the researchers will monitor the occurrence of three specific minor disruptive behaviors: (1) Unnecessary Side-Talking, defined as off-topic conversations with peers persisting for more than 5 seconds; (2) Inattentiveness / Off-Task Behavior, such as doodling, laying the head on the desk, or playing with objects uninterrupted for more than 5 seconds; and (3) Out-of-Seat Behavior, defined as leaving an assigned seat or switching chairs without teacher permission for more than 5 seconds. Interactions lasting 5 seconds or less, or permitted lesson-related interactions, will strictly not be tallied.

The primary data will be gathered through direct classroom observations using standardized tally sheets. To ensure instructional flow and data validity, the lead student-teacher will focus solely on facilitating the lesson and executing the intervention, while a designated co-researcher will be stationed at the back of the room acting strictly as the non-participant observer to record the behavioral frequencies.

Finally, to measure the quantitative frequency data with qualitative supporting evidence, short feedback handouts will be distributed to the students on the last day of the intervention phase. Students will use these handouts to write their personal reflections and feedback regarding their experience with the reward economy, providing valuable insight into their behavioral responses to the intervention.

Post Data Gathering

Finally, to determine the effectiveness of the Praise-and-Token System, the researchers will conduct their final observation during Week 5 using the observation tally sheet to help determine whether the identified minor disruptive behaviors are still apparent.

The researchers will retrieve, consolidate, and organize the completed observation checklists and tally sheets. The recorded frequencies will be organized according to the identified minor disruptive behaviors and the different phases of the study to make it easier to compare the observations and identify any changes following the implementation of the Praise-and-Token System.

The gathered data will be used to evaluate the observed changes in classroom behavior following the implementation of the Praise-and-Token System and to identify areas that may need improvement. The findings will serve as a basis for formulating conclusions and recommendations regarding the use of the intervention as a classroom management strategy. The primary users of the data will be the researchers, their research adviser, and the critique teacher. The findings may also be useful to other teachers and school administrators who are interested in exploring positive reinforcement strategies to help manage minor disruptive behaviors in the classroom. The data will be handled responsibly, with appropriate measures to protect the participants' identities and the confidentiality of the research records.

Data Analysis

To evaluate the effectiveness of the "Praise and Token" system in reducing minor disruptive behaviors, the gathered quantitative and qualitative data will be systematically

analyzed using appropriate statistical and thematic analysis tools aligned with the specific research questions:

1. Descriptive Statistics (Frequency Counts, Percentages, and Mean) To address Action Research Questions 1 and 2, descriptive statistics will be used to summarize the occurrence of minor disruptive behaviors observed during the pre-intervention baseline (O_1) and post-intervention (O_2) phases.

Frequency Counts (f): Total occurrences of each target behavior category (Unnecessary Side-Talking, Inattentiveness/Off-Task Behavior, and Out-of-Seat Behavior) will be tallied across all observed 45-minute sessions.

Percentage (%): Computed to determine the relative proportion of each disruption category to the overall total across lesson phases (Preliminaries, Main Discussion, Wrap-Up).

Mean ($\bar{X}$): The average number of disruptive behaviors recorded per session will be calculated to establish comparative baseline and post-intervention behavioral averages.

$$\bar{X} = \overline{\sum NX}$$

Where $\sum X$ is the total sum of observed disruptions across all sessions, and N is the total number of observed sessions).

2. Inferential Statistics (Paired Samples t-test) To address Action Research Question 3 ("Is there a significant difference in the frequency of minor disruptive behaviors before and after the integration of the intervention?"), a Paired Samples t-test will be performed using statistical software (e.g., SPSS or Jamovi) at a 0.05 level of significance.

The paired t-test is the appropriate parametric test for this One-Group Pre-test–Post-test design as it compares the mean scores of the same intact group under two different conditions (O_1 vs. O_2). A calculated p-value less than 0.05 () will indicate a statistically significant reduction in minor disruptive behaviors $p < 0.05$ following the implementation of the "Praise and Token" system.

$$t = \frac{\overline{D_s}}{\frac{N_D}{\sqrt{}}}$$

(Where D^- is the mean difference between baseline and post-test tallies, s_D is the standard deviation of the differences, and N is the number of paired observation sessions).

3. Qualitative Content and Thematic Analysis To address Action Research Question 4 ("How do the students respond to the use of custom peso bills as a reinforcement tool?"), qualitative data collected from the student feedback reflection handouts distributed at the end of the intervention will be analyzed using Thematic Analysis (Braun & Clarke, 2006). Student responses will be transcribed, coded, and categorized into recurring themes reflecting their motivation, perceived fairness, behavioral self-regulation, and engagement with the classroom currency economy.

Ethical Considerations

The conduct of this classroom-based action research strictly adheres to the ethical standards and research principles governing studies involving human participants, particularly minor learners in basic education. The researchers evaluated the risk-benefit ratio of the intervention to verify that all activities remain pedagogical, non-punitive, and fully integrated into regular, safe classroom instructional practices. Furthermore, the intervention avoids student stigmatization, public shaming, or academic penalties; instead, it proactively fosters an equitable and supportive classroom environment. To uphold the rights, welfare, and integrity of all participants, the following protocols are strictly observed:

- **Informed Consent and Learner Assent:** Because the participants are minors, formal written parental consent is secured prior to data gathering and intervention implementation. Concurrently, age-appropriate learner assent is obtained from the Grade 10 students, ensuring they clearly understand the purpose, nature, and activities of the study.
- **Voluntary Participation and Freedom from Coercion:** Participation is strictly voluntary. Students and their parents or guardians are explicitly informed of their right to withhold consent or withdraw from behavioral observation tracking at any stage without prejudice, academic penalty, or loss of standard classroom privileges and instructional support.
- **Confidentiality, Anonymity, and Data Privacy:** In strict adherence to Republic Act No. 10173, also known as the Data Privacy Act of 2012, all personal identification and sensitive behavioral records are handled with rigorous confidentiality. Student identities are protected by assigning unique alphanumeric identification codes on all observation tally sheets, rubrics, and documentation. The master list linking student names to their corresponding

codes is securely maintained solely by the researchers. Digital research records are password-protected and encrypted, while physical observation sheets are retained in secure storage and will be destroyed once the research evaluation cycle is officially concluded.

- **Equitable Treatment and Protection from Bias:** The implementation of the praise and token system is administered fairly across all learners. The criteria for earning Behavior-Specific Praise and tokens are made explicit and transparent to eliminate educator favoritism, bias, or the marginalization of struggling students, thereby safeguarding equal opportunity to receive recognition and incentives.

Informed Consent

Prior to the pre-data gathering phase and the implementation of the "Praise and Token" system, formal informed consent protocols will be strictly executed. Because the Grade 10 participants are minors, the researchers will secure written Parental/Guardian Consent forms detailing the nature, purpose, and activities of the classroom action research. Concurrently, age-appropriate Learner Assent will be obtained directly from the students to ensure they comprehend the study and willingly agree to participate.

During the orientation, it shall be made unequivocally clear to the participants and their parents that their participation in the study is strictly voluntary. They will be informed that they are not compelled to participate should they believe that involvement will be detrimental to their interest. Students retain the right to withdraw from the behavioral observation at any time without facing any academic penalties, deductions, or loss of standard instructional support from the student-teacher.

Furthermore, the participants will be explicitly informed that the research is conducted solely for academic purposes. The behavioral frequencies and redemption

data gathered from them shall be exclusively used for evaluating the effectiveness of the intervention and will not negatively influence their formal grades in the TLE - Food Service subject.

This completes all five of your assigned sections! You can now copy these directly into your shared Google Document.

Confidentiality Pledge

We, the undersigned researchers, solemnly pledge to uphold the highest ethical standards of confidentiality, academic integrity, and professional discretion throughout the planning, data collection, analysis, reporting, and dissemination phases of this Classroom-Based Action Research (CBAR).

In strict adherence to the provisions of Republic Act No. 10173, otherwise known as the Data Privacy Act of 2012, and the institutional research guidelines of the Department of Education (DepEd) and Technological University of the Philippines Taguig, we hereby commit to the following principles and protocols:

1. **Anonymity & Pseudonyms:** All participant identities, Learner Reference Numbers (LRNs), and identifying information will be replaced with alphanumeric codes (e.g., Learner A) across all observation forms and reports.

2. **Pedagogical Protection:** Behavioral data and observation tallies will be used solely to evaluate the intervention strategy and will never affect students' grades or be used for academic penalties.

3. **Secure Storage:** All digital data will be encrypted, and password-protected, physical records will remain locked, and access will be restricted exclusively to the research team.

4. **Aggregated Reporting:** Final findings and presentations will report general class wide trends only; individual learners will not be identifiable.

5. **Safe Disposal:** All observation sheets, master keys, and recorded notes will be securely deleted or shredded upon final academic defense and completion of the study.

***Authorization to Access Private Information*.**

October __ ,2026

Principal Delgado

Schools Principal II

Pres. Diosdado Macapagal High School

Subject: Request for Permission to Conduct Classroom-Based Action Research and Collect Data

Dear Principal Delgado:

Greetings from the pre-service teachers of the Technological University of the Philippines–Taguig!

We, the BTVTEd students of TUP–Taguig, respectfully request your permission to conduct our classroom-based action research entitled *"The Effectiveness of a 'Praise and Token' System in Reducing Minor Disruptive Behaviors Among Grade 10 Students in Pres. Diosdado Macapagal High School."* We aim to gather and document relevant information through classroom observations and observation tally sheets to support the accurate conduct of our research and contribute to improving the educational experiences of both students and educators.

In accordance with Republic Act No. 10173, also known as the Data Privacy Act of 2012, we will ensure that all collected data are handled with the utmost care and confidentiality. The gathered information will be used solely for academic and research purposes. We will follow the school's policies and procedures regarding data privacy and obtain the necessary permissions and consent before collecting or documenting information involving the participants.

We intend to gather the necessary data during class sessions over a period of five weeks. During these sessions, we will explain the intervention process and rules, document the occurrence of minor disruptive behaviors using observation tally sheets, and monitor changes in classroom behavior throughout the implementation of the Praise-and-Token System. Photographs or video recordings of the intervention materials and implementation process may also be collected as supporting documentation, subject to the necessary permissions and privacy safeguards.

We assure you that we will comply with the institution's policies and regulations and maintain proper professional conduct throughout the implementation of our research.

We sincerely hope for your favorable consideration of this request. Thank you very much for your time, consideration, and support.

Respectfully yours,

JOHN BRIX CORONEJO

The BTVTEd Student Researchers

EMMANUEL FERRER

The BTVTEd Student Researchers

ALIAH WALES

The BTVTEd Student Researchers

Noted By:

MS. ANNALYN P. TANTO

Research Facilitator

Resources

Adam Ismail, Ismail. (2023). *Using positive reinforcement to increase student engagement in the classroom* [Master's project, Minnesota State University Moorhead]. *Dissertations, Theses, and Projects*, 850. https://red.mnstate.edu/thesis/850

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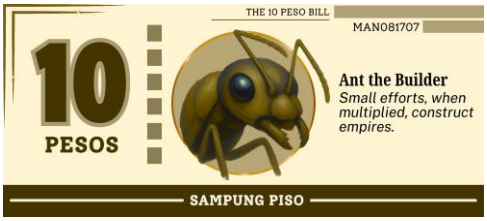
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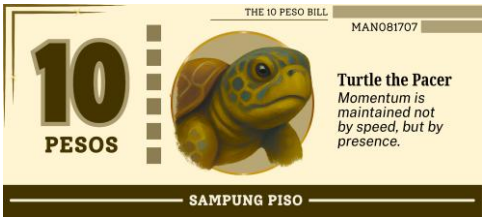
APPENDIX A:

Custom Classroom Currency Designs (Intervention Materials)

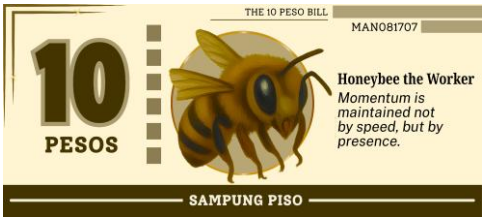
The following figures present the custom-designed, non-AI-generated classroom peso bills utilized as the primary tangible reinforcement in the "Praise and Token" system. Each denomination features a specific animal archetype and quote corresponding to the cognitive or behavioral effort required to earn it.














THE 50 PESO BILL
MAN081707
50
PESOS
Dog the Sentinel
Active listening and disciplined focus guard the standard.
LIMAMPUNG PISO


THE 100 PESO BILL
MAN081707
100
PESOS
Tarsier the Observer
Keen senses uncover the exact truths that others miss.
SANDAANG PISO


THE 50 PESO BILL
MAN081707
50
PESOS
Spider the Architect
Careful attention to the present weaves the success of tomorrow.
LIMAMPUNG PISO


THE 100 PESO BILL
MAN081707
100
PESOS
Eagle the Visionary
Seeing the whole picture allows the perfect strike.
SANDAANG PISO


THE 50 PESO BILL
MAN081707
50
PESOS
Carabao the Cultivator
Steady hands and a calm mind prepare the richest soil.
LIMAMPUNG PISO


THE 100 PESO BILL
MAN081707
100
PESOS
Owl the Wise
Clarity cuts through the dark; precision leaves no room for doubt.
SANDAANG PISO

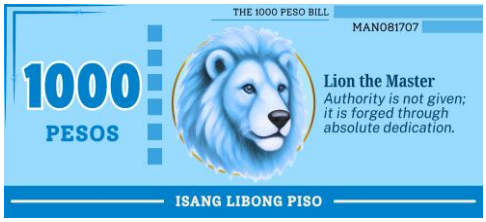

THE 500 PESO BILL
MAN081707
500
PESOS
Elephant the Monument
Heavy is the weight of sustained excellence.
LIMANG DAANG PISO


THE 1000 PESO BILL
MAN081707
1000
PESOS
Phoenix the Apex
From the fires of effort rises the ultimate triumph.
ISANG LIBONG PISO


THE 500 PESO BILL
MAN081707
500
PESOS
Bear the Prosperous
Endurance through seasons accumulates quiet abundance.
LIMANG DAANG PISO


THE 1000 PESO BILL
MAN081707
1000
PESOS
Bakunawa the Legend
Reach the peak, and the world reshapes around you.
ISANG LIBONG PISO


THE 500 PESO BILL
MAN081707
500
PESOS
Squirrel the Hoarder
Patience today yields the feast of tomorrow.
LIMANG DAANG PISO


THE 1000 PESO BILL
MAN081707
1000
PESOS
Lion the Master
Authority is not given; it is forged through absolute dedication.
ISANG LIBONG PISO

APPENDIX B:

Action Research Questionnaire/Tool

This appendix contains the primary data-gathering instruments utilized in the conduct of this action research. It is composed of two main tools designed to triangulate both quantitative and qualitative data regarding the implementation of the "Praise and Token" Classroom Currency Economy:

1. **Standardized Behavioral Observation Tally Sheet:** This quantitative instrument is utilized by the non-participant co-researcher to systematically record the frequency of the three targeted minor disruptive behaviors (unnecessary side-talking, inattentiveness/off-task behavior, and out-of-seat behavior). It incorporates a strict 5-second operational threshold rule to ensure the validity, consistency, and reliability of the baseline (O_1) and post-intervention (O_2) data across all 45-minute lesson phases.

2. **Student Feedback and Reflection Form:** This qualitative questionnaire is administered to the Grade 10 participants at the conclusion of the intervention phase. It is specifically designed to capture the learners' personal experiences, behavioral self-regulation, and perceived motivation regarding the custom peso bills and reward exchanges, directly addressing Action Research Question 4.

PRES. DIOSDADO MACAPAGAL HIGH SCHOOL
TLE DEPARTMENT

CLASSROOM-BASED ACTION RESEARCH (CBAR) OBSERVATION TOOL

Study Title: The Effectiveness of a "Praise and Token" System in Reducing Minor Disruptive Behaviors Among Grade 10 Students

Date of Observation: _____ **Time / Period:** _____

Grade & Section: Grade 10 - Azalea **Subject:** TLE - Food Service

Observation Phase: [ ] Baseline (Pre-test / O1) [ ] Post-Intervention (Post-test / O2)

Observer Name: _____ **Role:** [ ] Co-Researcher [ ] CT

OPERATIONAL DEFINITIONS & THRESHOLD RULES

1. **Unnecessary Side-Talking:** Off-topic conversation with peers that persists for **MORE THAN 5 SECONDS** while the teacher or a designated speaker is talking.
2. **Inattentiveness / Off-Task Behavior:** Doodling, laying head on desk, or playing with objects uninterrupted for **MORE THAN 5 SECONDS** during instruction.
3. **Out-of-Seat Behavior:** Leaving assigned seat or switching chairs without teacher permission for **MORE THAN 5 SECONDS**.

Note: *Interactions lasting 5 seconds or less, or permitted lesson-related interactions, are* ***NOT*** *tallied.*

OBSERVATION LOG (Phase-Based)

Lesson Phase	Target Disruptive Behavior Category	Frequency Tally (Ticks: e.g., ||||)
PHASE 1: Preliminaries (Greetings, Prayer, Review, Motivation/Energizer, etc.) Time Start: _____ End: _____	A. Unnecessary Side-Talking	
	B. Inattentiveness / Off-Task	
	C. Out-of-Seat Behavior	
PHASE 2: Main Discussion (Lesson Proper, Recitation, Active Group/Seatwork) Time Start: _____ End: _____	A. Unnecessary Side-Talking	
	B. Inattentiveness / Off-Task	
	C. Out-of-Seat Behavior	
PHASE 3: Wrap-Up (Assessment/Evaluation, Quiz, Generalization, Dismissal) Time Start: _____ End: _____	A. Unnecessary Side-Talking	
	B. Inattentiveness / Off-Task	
	C. Out-of-Seat Behavior	

SUMMARY OF TOTAL OBSERVED DISRUPTIONS

Total Unnecessary Side-Talking Instances:	
Total Inattentiveness Instances:	
Total Out-of-Seat Behavior Instances:	
GRAND TOTAL DISRUPTIONS FOR SESSION:	

OBSERVER QUALITATIVE NOTES / REMARKS

(Note any external factors like heat, rain noise, school announcements, or specific lesson phase)

_____

_____

STUDENT FEEDBACK AND REFLECTION FORM

The "Praise and Token" Classroom Currency Economy

Instructions: Thank you for participating in our Food Service classes! We want to hear your honest thoughts about the custom peso bills and reward system we used. There are no right or wrong answers, and your responses will not affect your grades. Please answer the questions below as honestly as you can.

Participant Code: _____ *(Leave blank if you prefer to be anonymous)* **Date:** _____

1. Motivation and Participation: Did earning the custom peso bills (₱10, ₱20, ₱50, ₱100) make you want to recite more or participate actively in class? Why or why not?

_____

_____

_____

_____

2. Classroom Behavior and Focus: Did the reward system help you avoid minor distractions (like side-talking with your seatmate or losing focus)? How did it affect your discipline during the lecture and seatwork?

_____

_____

_____

_____

3. The Exchange System (Fairness & Challenge): What do you think about the rules for saving up bills to exchange for the ₱500 and ₱1,000 academic grade boosts? Was it fair, too hard, or just right?

_____

_____

_____

_____

4. Overall Experience: What did you like the most about the classroom currency system? Is there anything you would change to make it better?

_____

_____

_____

_____

Thank you for your feedback!